



I Ching
The Book of Changes



I Ching The Book of Changes

For countless centuries emperor and peasant, scholar and unlearned alike have sought to understand the timeless wisdom and eerie divinations of the I Ching, translated, the Book of Changes. Using the simple tools of three coins, one can seek insight from the I Ching regarding whatever question is on one's heart.

荣誉

Using the I Ching

The Question

There is a question burning in your heart and mind. Think about it and then write it down, privately, on

a piece of paper. Writing the question down helps you to focus on the precise subject being asked about, thereby avoiding ambiguity. Be sure to word your question so that it requires a commentary type of answer... i.e., do not ask a question that requires a 'yes' or 'no' answer. For example, ask "What if..." or "What is this all about...?"

Casting the Coins

With your mind focused on the question you've written down, gather three coins of the same size into your hands, shake them until they are randomly arranged in your hand, then cast them gently upon the table in front of you. Notice how the coins have landed with either 'heads' or 'tails' facing up.

Building a Trigram

Match the 'heads or tails' pattern of the cast coins with one of the 4 patterns shown in the following table. Make note of the associated line form next to the matched pattern and write it down. (Note that if you cast three

of a kind, the line form will have a dot after it). Repeat this coin casting process 2 more times, each time placing the next line form on top of the previous one. Having done this 3 times, you will have a 3 line figure known as a trigram.

Example trigram

3rd cast →    .
 2nd cast →    .
 1st cast →    .



Building a Hexagram

You need to create 2 trigrams to make a full hexagram. So, create a second trigram using the same process above. When done you will have created a hexagram consisting of a lower trigram (the first one) and an upper trigram (the second one).

Example hexagram

6th cast →    Upper
 5th cast →    trigram
 4th cast →   
 3rd cast →    Lower
 2nd cast →    trigram
 1st cast →   

Finding the Hexagram

Cross reference the lower trigram with the upper trigram using the chart below. For the moment, ignore any dots that may appear beside any of the line forms. Make note of the hexagram number that the two trigrams form, and turn to the page with that number.

[illegible]

Interpreting the Hexagram

The hexagram you have created contains words of insight pertaining to your question. Seek to apply the words you're given to the question you asked, in a sincere and introspective way. Suspend preconceptions that may cloud your vision regarding the subject under consideration. Your intuition will confirm whether or not you have been enlightened.

Sometimes you may not understand the full meaning of your hexagram, as it relates to the question you asked. Whether or not so, be certain that the question you asked is the question that is truly the one most on your mind at the time you cast the coins.

Since the pattern of the falling coins is determined, in part, by the cosmic vibrations emanating from your mind, it is possible for the I Ching to answer the question that is really on your mind and not the one you wrote down, if the two are not the same.

If your Hexagram contains any 'Dotted' line forms

You may have cast one or more "three-of-a-kind" patterns (3-heads or 3-tails) resulting in a 'dotted' line form in your hexagram. If so, there remains further information for you from the I Ching. The dotted line means that your hexagram is soon to undergo a change. To learn how it is going to change, you

must transform the current hexagram into its future form. You do this by converting the dotted line forms into their opposite forms, that is solid lines become dashed lines and dashed lines become solid lines. For example...

Using the procedure described above, look up the meaning of the second hexagram, realizing that this

First Hexagram		Second Hexagram changing to ...
5th cast	=====	=====
5th cast	=====	=====
4th cast	=====	=====
	→	
3rd cast	=====	=====
2nd cast	=====	=====
1st cast	=====	=====
	→	

second hexagram is predicting a likely future condition regarding the question that you've asked.



**Hexagram 1:
Heaven above
Heaven below.
Yielding.**

The universe is united in power. So too the wise person executes his actions with power and creativity. Exceptional progress comes by correct persistence.



**Hexagram 2:
Earth above, Earth below.
Yielding.**

The receptive earth is in power. The wise person follows the natural path of calmness and correct persistence. Others may lead while you support their goals.



**Hexagram 3:
Water above,
Thunder below.
Confusion.**



Thunderclouds indicate profound disquiet. Undertake no distant goal, but organize support. Concern yourself with the problems of the moment.

**Hexagram 4:
Mountain above,
Water below.
Inexperience.**



As spring water collects at the base of the quiet mountain, the enlightened person finds his level through learning, decisiveness, and correct persistence.

**Hexagram 5:
Water above,
Heaven below.
Waiting.**



Clouds of anxiety rise. Do not be anxious, but wait with confidence. The moment will arrive when correct persistence brings progress.

**Hexagram 6:
Heaven above,
Water below.
Conflict.**



Heaven and water, strength and profundity, conflict. Avoid confrontation, yield with caution, persist not against obstacles.

**Hexagram 7:
Earth above, Water below.
Cooperation.**



The receptive earth holds the water, and the wise person will find strength in the company of many fellows. With leadership there will be correct persistence and good fortune.

**Hexagram 8:
Water above, Earth below.
Unity.**



The receptive earth beneath, with profundity above, indicates the need for unity and collective awareness of the goal. Do not procrastinate. Join with others and return to the plan.

**Hexagram 9:
Wind above,
Heaven below.
Restraint.**



The winds of gradual change, supported by the strength of Heaven, shows that restraint brings progress and satisfaction. Make minor changes and conceal all actions.

**Hexagram 10:
Heaven above,
Lake below.
Correct conduct.**

The excessive beneath, the strong above. Discriminate between the inferior and superior to achieve progress. Change gives way to stability.

**Hexagram 11:
Earth above,
Heaven below
Prosperity.**



The strength of Heaven mingles with the receptive earth. The wise leader benefits from this harmony. Good fortune approaches.

**Hexagram 12:
Heaven above,
Earth below.
Stagnation.**



The strong and the receptive do not meet. Strong persons give way to the inferior. The enlightened person remains reserved to avoid misfortune. No advantage in persistence.

**Hexagram 13:
Heaven above,
Fire below.
Community.**



Strength of heaven, dependence of fire. Recognize the dependence of all upon their fellows. The wise person seeks the collective flow to gain advantage.

**Hexagram 14:
Fire above,
Heaven below.
Sovereignty.**



The strength of heaven holds a fiery intelligence, the maker of an enlightened ruler. Resist evil; exalt good. Proper Leadership brings great progress.

**Hexagram 15:
Earth above,
Mountain below.
Moderation.**



The tranquil mountain amid the receptive earth indicates great progress through the reduction of excess. Progress comes by equality of extremes.

**Hexagram 16:
Thunder above,
Earth below.
Harmony**



From the receptive earth comes the loud thunder. So from harmony with supporters does the wise person gain advantage.

**Hexagram 17:
Lake above,
Thunder below.
Flexibility.**



In the midst of excess, growth and persistence produces progress. The enlightened person adapts, and leads the way from darkness to comfort.

**Hexagram 18:
Mountain above,
Wind below.
Repair.**



Winds of gradual change wear away the mountain. Cultivate action in others to bring about repair and great progress. If starting, meditate on the future.

Hexagram 19:
Earth above, Lake below.
Promotion.



The earth above reflects in the lake beneath. So is the enlightened person willing to teach and learn from others. Progress comes through persistence.

Hexagram 20:
Wind above, Earth below.
Contemplation.



As the wind moves over the earth, so too the rulers of old travelled the world. They visited its regions and contemplated its many cultures. Explore new ideas.

Hexagram 21:
Fire above,
Thunder below.
Reform.



The turbulence of thunder and lightning indicates the need for change. Achieve progress through reform. Administer justice.

Hexagram 22:
Mountain above,
Fire below.
Serenity.



Illumination reveals the foot of the immovable mountain. So the wise person perceives and avoids disputes. No progress except in small matters.

**Hexagram 23:
Mountain above,
Earth below.
Deterioration.**



The weak earth cannot support the mountain. The realm deteriorates. Enlightened people stabilize their lives through generosity toward the needy.

**Hexagram 24:
Earth above,
Thunder below.
Repetition.**



The beginning of a new cycle shows that repetition brings new progress toward a goal. Friends return. The repeating cycle is part of the Way.

**Hexagram 25:
Heaven above,
Thunder below.
Spontaneity.**



Strength above and activity below indicates an alignment with a natural state. Act with persistence and inspiration, but without a true goal.

**Hexagram 26:
Mountain above,
Heaven below.
Potential.**



The strength of the Heavens comes from within the mountain. The enlightened person studies the past's wisdom to develop his own character.

**Hexagram 27:
Mountain above,
Thunder below.
Nurturing.**



Energy stirs beneath immobility. Support goals that are above question, but be cautious in expression and avoid the negative. Correct persistence brings one good fortune.

**Hexagram 28:
Lake above, Wind below.
Imminent change.**



The enlightened person withdraws from the world to progress toward an independent goal. Stress is imminent.

**Hexagram 29:
Water above,
Water below.
Danger.**



Profundity produces difficulty. The wise person learns confidence through danger. Remain calm in mind, keep all actions virtuous.

**Hexagram 30:
Fire above, Fire below.
Enlightened intelligence.**



Intelligence shines above and below. The enlightened person cultivates intelligence and gains progress through correct persistence. Align yourself with goals that bring enlightenment.

**Hexagram 31:
Lake above,
Mountain below.
Attraction.**



Tranquility combined with excess produces pleasure. Marriage brings good fortune. Accept others and act openly. All change is imminent.

**Hexagram 32:
Thunder above,
Wind below.
Continuity.**



Activity and change teach well the value of endurance. Stand firm and move with persistence toward a goal. Freedom from error.

**Hexagram 33:
Heaven above,
Mountain below.
Retreat.**



The tranquil mountain remains quiet under Heaven's gaze. So does the enlightened person maintain dignity in retreat. Persist only in small matters, and avoid mean conflict.

**Hexagram 34:
Thunder above,
Heaven below.
Power.**



Activity in the light of day. The wise person acts within convention and with persistence. Use influence wisely.

Hexagram 35:
Fire above, Earth below.
Progress.



The sun rises above the earth. So does the enlightened person reveal virtue. Conditions favorable for progress. Help others through cleverness and virtue.

Hexagram 36:
Fire above, Earth below.
Subtlety.



Intelligence is hidden within the earth. Conceal goals, but do not abandon them. Trying conditions, but correct persistence brings one advantage.

Hexagram 37:
Wind above, Fire below.
Family.



Winds of change issue from intelligent action. The enlightened person acts in an orderly and substantial way. Faith and loyalty must be nurtured.

Hexagram 38:
Fire above, Lake below.
Contradiction.



Intelligence contradicts excess. The enlightened person acts only in small matters. Maintain individuality.

**Hexagram 39:
Water above,
Mountain below.
Obstacles.**



Profound movement meets immobility. The enlightened person examines and perfects his own behavior to gain strength.

**Hexagram 40:
Thunder above,
Water below.
Liberation.**



Rain and thunder indicate profound activity. The enlightened person finds good fortune in quick action to restore normal conditions. Forgive others' faults.

**Hexagram 41:
Mountain above,
Lake below.
Decline.**



Excess is held by immobility. The enlightened person acts with moderation. Avoid anger, develop confidence. Sacrifice brings good fortune, freedom from error.

**Hexagram 42:
Wind above,
Thunder below,
Benefit.**



Growth brings benefit. An enlightened person sees the good actions of his fellows, imitate them and correct their mistakes to make progress toward a goal.

Hexagram 43:
Lake above,
Heaven below.
Resolve.



Excess, drawn into Heaven's gaze, produces honesty. Do not use force, but rely on fair judges. Know your goal, tell your supporters.

Hexagram 44:
Heaven above,
Wind below.
Temptation.



Heaven's power makes stronger the wind of change. So too a ruler issues commands that become well known. Do not create a relationship with powerful persons or ideas. Exert discipline.

Hexagram 45:
Lake above, Earth below.
Assembly.



The earth receives excess. Unite with others, make sacrifices, and act with correct persistence to achieve a goal. Act with sincerity, avoid suspicion, and join with a wise leader.

Hexagram 46:
Earth above, Wind below.
Advancement.



Gradual change, nourished by the receptive earth, produces a path to virtue. The enlightened person persists in small matters to gain fortune. Approach leaders without fear.

Hexagram 47:
Lake above, Water below.
Adversity.



Excess lacks profundity. The enlightened person gains progress through courage. Adversity needs risks to achieve fortune. Speaking alone is ineffective.

Hexagram 48:
Water above, Wind below.
Insight.



Profound penetration and change. Truth is never exhausted, yet never the same. The enlightened person gains insight into truth and assists others to achieve it. If the truth is not heeded, bad fortune follows.

Hexagram 49:
Lake above, Fire below.
Change.



Intelligent consciousness amid excess produces change. The enlightened person appreciates past experience and present opportunity. Confidence and progress only after change is past.

Hexagram 50:
Fire above, Wind below.
Order.



Intelligence combined with penetration makes progress and good fortune. The wise person aligns himself with the established order.

**Hexagram 51:
Thunder above,
Thunder below.
Shock.**



Repeated activity produces sudden surprise and fear. The enlightened person seeks to improve himself and take advantage of the unpredictable.

**Hexagram 52:
Mountain above,
Mountain below.
Meditation.**



Tranquility upon tranquility. The enlightened person turns his back upon the larger situation and loses self awareness. Should he not notice anyone else, there is no error.

**Hexagram 53:
Wind above,
Mountain below.
Development.**



Penetrating change moves the immobile mountain. The enlightened person improves life through good conduct and correct persistence. Marriage brings good fortune.

**Hexagram 54:
Thunder above,
Lake below.
Passivity.**



Action above, excess below. The enlightened person in current difficulty takes no action but considers the near future. Seek no goal.

**Hexagram 55:
Thunder above,
Fire below.
Peeking intelligence.**



Intelligence combined with activity. This is the zenith of achievement. The enlightened person trusts his own judgment and makes progress. Do not fear decline, but shine like the sun.

**Hexagram 56:
Fire above,
Mountain below.
Travel.**



Illumination upon the quiet mountain makes conditions favorable for travel. The wise person is clear-minded and not detained by disputes.

**Hexagram 57:
Wind above, Wind below.
Influence.**



Penetrating change above and below. The enlightened person acts gradually and only toward small goals. Wait and consider larger perspectives.

**Hexagram 58:
Lake above, Lake below.
Encouragement.**



Openness and excess above and below. The wise person exchanges ideas with others to find cooperation. Progress and advantage in correct persistence.

Hexagram 59:
Wind above, Water below.
Reunion.



Gradual change above the profound water. Rulers meet with their subordinates. Advantage in cooperation, correct persistence, and the company of fellows.

Hexagram 60:
Lake below, Water above.
Limitation.



Profundity is held in check by excess. The wise person develops sound restraints and decides proper conduct. Extreme limitation, though, is no virtue.

Hexagram 61:
Wind above, Lake below.
Understanding.



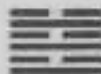
Penetrating change above the open lake. From a distance the wise person gains understanding. Moderate disputes, and must avoid rigidity.

Hexagram 62:
Thunder above,
Mountain below,
Attention to detail.



As the mountain remains tranquil in activity, so the wise person conducts himself with dignity and control. Be remorseful in losses and frugal in expenses. When birds fly too high, none hear their song.

Hexagram 63:
Water above, Fire below.
Precaution.



In consciousness is bred profound difficulty. The enlightened person defends against forthcoming adversity. Progress only in small matters. Confusion is imminent.

Hexagram 64:
Fire above, Water below.
Vigilance.



Consciousness above the difficult water. The wise person attends his position and progress carefully. Progress with great vigilance.

